

CMI HTQ UNIT 551

Assessment Brief: Managing a Project • V1.0



KEY INFORMATION FOR LEARNERS

Overview of assessment tasks

Each task in this assessment brief has been developed to enable you to evidence achievement of the learning outcomes and Assessment Criteria for **CMI HTQ Unit 551: Managing a Project**. Each of the Assessment Criteria must gain a pass outcome for you to successfully achieve the unit.

Preparation for the assessment

- Please read the **CMI HTQ Unit 551: Managing a Project** specification thoroughly as only the content related to the achievement of the Assessment Criteria will be assessed.
- Research the topics being assessed. Suggested reading/webresources are provided in the **CMI HTQ Unit 551: Managing a Project** specification. Your tutor may signpost you to relevant resources. Additionally, you may access excellent online resources at ManagementDirect <https://members.md.cmi.org.uk>
- Please read the definitions of the command verbs used in the Assessment Criteria (for example. evaluate, discuss, analyse) at <https://www.managers.org.uk/wp-content/uploads/2020/03/Command-Verb-Definitions.pdf>

Completing the assessment brief

- The assessment brief contains a series of tasks which are clearly referenced to the relevant Assessment Criteria.
- Refer to the Assessment Guidance Table at the end of the assessment brief which outlines the requirements for a Pass or Refer.
- Evidence for assessment must be presented in the Assessment Booklet or other suitable format.
- If work based evidence is used, such as plans or documentation (which has been referred to within the main text, it should be included in the 'Work Based Evidence' section in the Assessment Booklet.
- Appendices are not a requirement of this assessment brief. If appendices are included these will not be marked or moderated by CMI.
- Work based evidence, where included, must not exceed SIX (6) pages. All evidence should be combined within the Assessment Booklet.
- Any assessment templates that have been created to support this unit are located in the Assessment Booklet.
- The Assessment Booklet must be completed in a professional manner (for example applying business conventions for writing formal reports) and by using Microsoft Word, Rich Text Format or another compatible software programme.
- The Assessment Booklet must be saved as a word document (.doc or .docx) and not in a PDF format.
- An appropriate referencing system (such as Harvard Referencing) must be used to ensure the original source(s) of quotations or models can be verified. Please refer to Reference and Citations Study guide at <https://www.managers.org.uk/~media/Files/PDF/Study%20Support/References-and-Citations.pdf>
- Finally, you must complete and sign the Learner Statement of Authenticity (an electronic signature is accepted).

Learner support

For information regarding policies and procedures for assessment (for example reasonable adjustments, learner support appeals, complaints, certification, confidentiality, plagiarism) you should contact your tutor or Centre manager and refer to the CMI Level 5 Diploma in Operational Management syllabus.

ASSESSMENT BRIEF: HTQ UNIT 551: MANAGING A PROJECT

Assessment brief CMI HTQ Unit 551 has been designed to facilitate learners in demonstrating their proficiency in project management. This unit focuses on the knowledge and skills required to manage projects successfully and overcome problems and challenges. It requires the learner to evaluate the methods and tools for planning tasks and activities, as well as knowing how to implement and manage project activities, build stakeholder relationships, manage resources and risk, monitor progress and report on outcomes.

ASSESSMENT TASKS AND WORD COUNT

Assessment brief **CMI HTQ Unit 551: Managing a Project** features the following assessment tasks. Further detail is provided against each assessment task within the brief.

Assessment Task		Learning outcomes covered by assessment method	Assessment Criteria	L5 ODM KSB	Guideline word count
1	Write a report titled: Principles and Processes in Project Management	LO1 Understand principles and processes for initiating, planning and managing projects	1.1 Define the principles of project management 1.2 Explain the purpose of projects in delivering organisational goals 1.3 Outline the process for initiating projects 1.4 Examine the tools and techniques to plan and manage projects in different contexts	K5 K6 K7 K8 K20	Approx. 2500 words
		LO2 Know the impact of legal, organisational and ethical factors on projects	2.1 Examine the impact of legal, organisational and ethical factors on projects		
2	Create a Project Plan to deliver an organisational goal	LO3 Be able to design, develop and manage a project to achieve results	3.1 Create a project proposal to deliver an organisational goal	S5 S6 S7 S8 S14 S17 S21 S22 B1 B2 B3 B4	Approx. 3500 words
			3.2 Consider methods for reporting on project outcomes		
			3.3 Specify methods of managing data and information in a project environment		
			3.4 Examine approaches to identify, manage and mitigate project risks		
		LO4 Be able to monitor and manage the factors	4.1 Evaluate methods used for monitoring project progress		

		which contribute to effective project management	4.2 Use effective problem solving and decision making techniques when managing projects		
			4.3 Outline approaches for project closure		

Guideline word count

The written word, whether generated and/or recorded, is expected to form the majority of assessable work produced by Learners at Level 5. The amount and volume of written work for this unit should be broadly comparable to a word count of **6000** words within a margin of +/-10%. The unit also includes additional work in the form of work based evidence. Excessive use of word count is not grounds for referral, however, the CMI reserves the right to return work to the Centre for editing and resubmission by the Learner.

The following are excluded from the written word count: Index or contents pages, headings and subheadings, diagrams, images, figures, charts and graphs, bibliography or references.

If you require further guidance on assessment, please ask your centre to refer to [CMI's Quality Assurance Handbook](#).

PRINCIPLES AND PROCESSES IN PROJECT MANAGEMENT

Understanding project management principles and processes is essential for aspiring project managers to build the necessary knowledge and skills. Defining project management principles offers fundamental insights into core concepts and methodologies. Recognising the purpose of projects in achieving organisational goals underscores the strategic importance of effective project management. Exploring tools and techniques for project initiation, planning and management empowers adaptability to diverse project contexts. Understanding the impact of legal, organisational, and ethical factors ensures responsible and compliant project management, fostering stakeholder trust.

TASK 1

You are required to produce a **report** titled: 'Principles and Processes in Project Management'

Your report should demonstrate a clear understanding of project management principles, processes, and the influence of legal, organisational, and ethical factors on projects.

Use the following headings to structure your report

1. Introduction

Begin your report with an overview of project management and its significance in achieving organisational goals.

2. Defining Project Management Principles

Define the principles of project management and discuss their relevance in project planning and execution. (AC1.1)

3. Project Contribution to Organisational Goals

Explain how projects contribute to achieving organisational goals and sustaining competitive advantage. (AC1.2)

4. Process for Initiating Projects:

Outline the process for initiating projects, including key steps and considerations. (AC1.3)

5. Examination of Tools and Techniques:

Examine various tools and techniques used in project planning and management, considering different project contexts and requirements. (AC1.4)

6. Impact of Legal, Organisational, and Ethical Factors:

Evaluate the impact of legal, organisational, and ethical factors on project success, providing examples where applicable. (AC2.1)

7. Conclusion:

Conclude your report summarising the key points discussed and highlighting the importance of understanding project management principles and factors influencing project outcomes.

Guidance for completion of Task 1

- *You must ensure that the report addresses all required components and demonstrates an understanding of project management principles and processes.*
- *It is recommended that all CMI Assessment Criteria for this task are clearly addressed within the main body, conclusion and recommendations sections of your report. It is also good practice to indicate where the Assessment Criteria have been addressed.*
- *Your report should be underpinned with relevant theoretical principles and references to relevant models and frameworks.*
- *At level 5, learners are expected to demonstrate a basic understanding of academic research and critical thinking skills. They should be able to conduct literature reviews, gather and evaluate sources, and use evidence to support their arguments. Students are expected to demonstrate critical thinking by analysing information, identifying patterns or trends, and making logical conclusions.*
- *The account should include appropriate headings and subheadings as indicated to organise the content clearly. You may choose to include tables and diagrams (as appropriate, but avoid over-reliance on these visual aids). Ensure all tables and diagrams are clearly labelled and indicate their sources.*
- *Appendices will not be assessed.*
- *Please refer to the indicative content for each Assessment Criteria outlined in the unit specification.*
- *Word limit will be 2500 words (+/- 10% at the apprentice's discretion), excluding tables, graphs, figures, references and annexes.*

MANAGING A PROJECT

The ability to manage projects is a vital skill for all managers. This assessment task has been written to enable operational or departmental managers to evidence their understanding of how to manage projects successfully and overcome problems and challenges.

Creating a project proposal serves as a practical exercise for students to demonstrate their competency in project management. It allows students to apply theoretical knowledge to a real-world scenario by planning and organising a project from start to finish. Through crafting a project proposal, students can showcase their ability to define project objectives, outline project scope, develop a feasible plan, identify the different roles and responsibilities, allocate resources (such as human, finance and physical but not limited too) effectively, identify and mitigate risks, and communicate their ideas clearly, in a structured and logical manner and persuasively. Additionally, creating a project proposal helps learners develop critical thinking, problem-solving, decision-making and communication skills essential for successful project management in various professional settings.

TASK 2

You are required to create a **Project Plan** to deliver an organisational goal. The goal may relate to improving efficiency, launching a new product or service, implementing a process improvement initiative, or any other objective relevant to the organisation's mission and strategic priorities. Your plan must outline your proposed project and its potential impact.

The **Plan** must address the following areas:

- **Introduction:** Introduce the project by providing background information, context, the problem or opportunity it aims to address, and a clear rationale for the project's importance.
- **Project Objectives:** Clearly state the specific, measurable objectives that the project aims to achieve (AC 3.1)
- **Scope of Work:** Define the boundaries of the project, including what is included and excluded from the project deliverables (AC 3.1)
- **Methodology/Approach:** Describe the overall approach or methodology that will be used to manage, execute and monitor the project, including the techniques used to collate and analyse data and information and project management tools used (AC 3.3)
- **Project Deliverables:** Identify and describe the specific deliverables that will be produced as a result of the project (AC 3.1)
- **Timeline/Schedule:** Provide a detailed timeline or schedule for the project, including key milestones and deadlines (AC 3.1)
- **Budget:** Present a comprehensive budget for the project, including costs for resources, materials, and any other expenses (AC 3.1)
- **Resource Requirements:** Detail the resources (such as human, financial, technological, but not limited too) needed to execute the project successfully, including (AC 3.1)
- **Risk Management:** Identify and examine potential risks and uncertainties that may impact the project's success and describe mitigation strategies (AC 3.4)
- **Stakeholder Analysis:** Identify all stakeholders involved in the project and analyse their roles, interests, and level of influence (AC 3.1)

- **Communication Plan:** Outline the communication strategy for the project, including how information will be reported to relevant stakeholders and the methods to be used (AC 3.2)
- **Quality Assurance/Control:** Describe how quality will be managed throughout the project lifecycle, including quality assurance and control processes and methods (AC 4.1)
- **Evaluation/Measurement:** Explain how the project's success will be evaluated and measured against its objectives, considering the strengths and weaknesses of the methods chosen (AC 4.1)
- **Problem Solving and Decision Making Techniques:** Consider the problems that may occur as part of the project and identify techniques to help overcome them and how they will be applied effectively (AC 4.2)
- **Project Closure:** Describe how you will bring the project to a close, outlining the approaches, the key considerations and steps that you would take (AC 4.3)

Guidance for completion of Task 2

- *There is no requirement for the learner to manage or deliver a live project for this assessment task.*
- *You must ensure that the plan addresses all required components and demonstrates an understanding of how to manage a project to deliver organisational goals, covering the required Assessment Criteria.*
- *Your plan should be underpinned with relevant theoretical principles (where applicable) and references made to relevant models and frameworks. At level 5, learners are expected to demonstrate a basic understanding of academic research and critical thinking skills. They should be able to conduct literature reviews, gather and evaluate sources, and use evidence to support their arguments. Students are expected to demonstrate critical thinking by analysing information, identifying patterns or trends, and making logical conclusions.*
- *The plan should include appropriate headings and subheadings as indicated to organise the content clearly. You may choose to include tables and diagrams (as appropriate but avoid over-reliance on these visual aids). Ensure all tables and diagrams are clearly labelled and indicate their sources.*
- *Appendices will not be assessed.*
- *Please refer to the indicative content for each Assessment Criteria outlined in the unit specification.*
- *Word limit will be 3500 words (+/- 10% at the apprentice's discretion), excluding tables, graphs, figures, references and annexes.*

ASSESSMENT GUIDANCE

Refer	Pass
• Not all Assessment Criteria have been met • No examples were used or the examples given do not match the requirements of the Assessment Criteria • Evidence is - • Unclear • Technically incorrect or inaccurate • Biassed • Includes unprofessional language • Poorly structured and presented • Lacks sufficient detail to show understanding of the topic • The application of different theories or approaches is incorrect, unclear or inappropriate • Evidence is not directly attributable to the learner • Evidence of plagiarism, collusion, cheating • External sources of information are not acknowledged • Work based evidence does not meet the requirements of the Assessment Criteria and the occupational standard, and are not current (within the period of the technical education or apprenticeship programme)	• All Assessment Criteria have been met • Examples given are well chosen and match the requirements of the Assessment Criteria • Evidence is - • Well written and presented • Contains a breadth of examples • Accurate • Current • Authentic • Inclusive • Coherent • Credible • Technically correct • Evidence shows understanding of different theories or approaches, is clear and appropriate • Evidence used from external sources has been correctly cited and referenced • Evidence is directly attributable to the learner • Work based evidence does meet the requirements of the Assessment Criteria and the occupational standard, and are current (within the period of the technical education or apprenticeship programme)